The causes for Détente can be seen as many. Some of the major factors leading to détente are:

Attainment of Strategic Parity by the Superpowers: The shift in the balance of power signalled a shift in the policies of both the superpowers towards the path of détente. The USA so long used its Strategic Air Command (SAC), later supplemented by the navy's nuclear submarines, to deter the Red Army. The US bombers and missiles deterred the Soviets with their implied threat of destroying their cities. But this strategic superiority, that was enjoyed by the United States was soon challenged by the Soviets. The American–Soviet balance had been asymmetric so far: the USA enjoyed strategic superiority and an intercontinental reach, and the Soviet Union enjoyed conventional superiority and a regional reach. But the Soviets gained its inter-continental capability and capacity of destroying USA as well as Western Europe from its massive build-up that began after 1964. The number of Soviet intercontinental missiles had surpassed the number of American land-based missiles. As Northedge and Grieve[13] observed, "The fear of thermonuclear war, which could annihilate both sides, and determination to avoid the kind of confrontations between two superpowers from which thermonuclear war could spring".

American Compulsions: The first and the foremost factor, which compelled the United States to walk in the path of détente, was the rising public opinion which was very much critical about America's role as a "global policeman". The mood within the United States reflected its weariness resulting from its foreign policy burdens. For Nixon and Ford, détente was necessary until the nation could "recover its nerve" and once more play the leading role. Therefore, détente was required to protect the US interests against Soviet expansion. The Vietnam debacle had placed the United States in a difficult position. Due to heavy involvement in the Vietnam War huge amount of US resources had to be committed. The more the Americans fought, the higher was the morale of the North Vietnam and the Viet Cong. Even extensive bombing by the United States could not prevent escalation of the war on the part of North Vietnam. But the US involvement in the warfare and massive bombing raised